MODELED SCENARIO FOR ACADEMIC USE

AI Governance Strategy for Sentinel Cyber Defense Branch

Governed Speed

How the Sentinel Cyber Defense Branch can capture AI speed in authorization and incident decisions and prove at every step that accountable humans remain in control.

Prepared for:	Branch Chief (Executive Sponsor) and the proposed SCDB AI Review Board
Prepared by:	Tomeeka L. Sibley, Proposed Director of AI Governance
Decision requested:	Approve Phase 1 (Days 0–90), the governance foundation, and three evidence gates
Program:	MIT Professional Education, Applied AI for Digital Transformation. Required Capstone Assignment 8.1. Instructor: Lee Bogner
Date and version:	Version 3.2 | October 26, 2026

> **About this scenario.** Sentinel Cyber Defense Branch (SCDB) is a modeled organization informed by my military, Defense Intelligence Agency continuity, and cybersecurity leadership experience. It does not describe a real unit or a former employer. Staffing, workloads, ratings, and targets are planning assumptions to validate against real baselines; no pilot result is claimed.

Executive Summary

SCDB should adopt AI with strong governance rather than bypass it. I recommend a three-phase approach: start with an internal, reviewable quick win, build verified data and reviewer skills, and then advance AI to operational decisions. Each phase ends at an evidence gate, where the AI Review Board recommends and the Branch Chief decides whether to scale, restrict, redesign, or stop.

> **4,800 hours of annual Risk Management Framework (RMF) evidence writing are addressable; the Month 12 target frees approximately 1,920 gross hours (about one full-time position), worth an estimated $173,000 a year in fully loaded labor cost (assumption). It becomes cash savings only where contractor or overtime spending is avoided. Three evidence gates control expansion. Zero escaped unsupported claims are tolerated in products released to an Authorizing Official (AO) or commander.**

Situation:	Staff can already reach enterprise generative AI, including GenAI.mil (Department of War, 2025), and informal use is growing faster than oversight.
Complication:	NSPM-11 links AI adoption with accountability (The White House, 2026). SCDB's missing inventory, approval route, and evaluation standard leave a fluent but false claim able to reach an AO or commander. Local policy applicability must be confirmed before use.
Resolution:	A risk-tiered portfolio of three use cases, sequenced by how early errors can be caught, with named owners, measurable gates, and pre-agreed stop conditions.

THE PORTFOLIO AT A GLANCE

Horizon	Use case	Mission outcome	Human authority retained
Quick win Days 0–90	AI-Drafted Control Implementation Statements for RMF Authorization Packages	Faster authorization preparation; security managers freed for risk analysis	Security manager verifies and signs; AO accepts security risk
Medium-term bet Months 6–18	Evidence-Grounded Cyber Incident Executive Brief	Faster, verified commander updates	Incident commander verifies and releases
Long-term ambition Month 18+	Mission-Impact Cyber Risk Picture for Commanders	Cyber risk expressed as mission risk	Commanders own every prioritization

USE BOUNDARIES

- AI may not take autonomous action on production networks, such as pushing firewall blocks.
- AI may not score personnel for insider-threat or clearance decisions.
- AI may process data only in permitted environments, and outputs may be released only after named human verification.

1 Strategic Context and AI Readiness

Recommendation: approve a bounded 90-day pilot of AI-drafted security control statements, with an inventory, risk tiers, and evidence gates before operational use.

Sentinel Cyber Defense Branch (SCDB) is a modeled 210-person cybersecurity organization serving 14,000 users across eleven sites and maintaining 38 systems under the Risk Management Framework (RMF). As the proposed Director of AI Governance, I base these planning assumptions on my continuity and cyber experience.

AI maturity is emerging. Staff have access to enterprise generative AI, but SCDB lacks a complete inventory, approval process, and evaluation standard. Leaders cannot identify which outputs influence authorization or incident decisions.

SCDB faces pressure to accelerate authorization preparation and provide verified incident updates. Its approach is to use reviewable drafting before operational automation. The Information System Security Manager (ISSM) Lead will reinvest verified capacity into evidence review and report reassigned hours and review quality each month.

Data is the primary constraint: fragmented records and unclear markings prevent safe reuse. The next challenge is untested AI verification skills among staff. Culture is an opportunity: exercises and after-action reviews support challenge and correction. Exhibit 1 assigns Day 30 validation for all four readiness dimensions.

EXHIBIT 1 Readiness Constraints and Day 30 Validation

Dimension	Rating	Scenario evidence and consequence	Day 30 validation (owner)
Data	1 / 5	Records are fragmented and markings uncertain, which prevents reliable reuse and safe aggregation.	Inventory pilot packages and sample incident records; log provenance, access, dates, and classification referrals; exclude unresolved inputs (Data Steward)
People	2 / 5	Deep cyber expertise, but AI verification skill is untested; missed errors could enter official records.	Baseline seeded-error drill for all ten pilot reviewers; record workload and training needs (Governance Lead)
Technology	2 / 5	Enterprise AI access exists; permitted data, features, and integrations are unconfirmed. Access is not readiness.	Confirm authorization boundary, allowed data categories, model version visibility, and retention (System Owner)
Culture	2 / 5	Exercises and after-action reviews are routine (opportunity); willingness to challenge AI under pressure is untested.	Confidential feedback and a stop-the-tool exercise; no penalty for raising concerns (Team Leads)

Scale: 1 = absent, 2 = ad hoc, 3 = documented in a bounded pilot, 4 = demonstrated repeatedly, 5 = monitored branch-wide. A proposed local scale, not a validated instrument; overall maturity is judged, not averaged.

2 AI Opportunity Map

The Opportunity Map prioritizes three uses; Appendix A also records two deferred candidates. Exposure ratings describe tasks, not entire jobs, and require pilot validation.

1. AI-Drafted Control Implementation Statements for RMF Authorization Packages. Value: high. Twelve annual updates at an assumed 400 hours each expose 4,800 addressable writing hours. A 40% reduction

frees about 1,920 hours, worth roughly $173,000 a year. Drafting has high proposed AI exposure because artifacts and formats repeat; people retain evidence interpretation and attestation. Feasibility: high for approved document bundles. Risk: medium, including governance and ethical risk: an unsupported statement could give the Authorizing Official (AO) false assurance. A qualified security manager verifies every material claim.

2. Evidence-Grounded Cyber Incident Executive Brief. Value: high; an assumed three to four hours per major incident go to updates. Summarization has high proposed exposure, but commanders retain uncertainty assessment and response judgment. Feasibility: medium; permissions, test cases, and evaluation need preparation. Risk: high. Invented indicators, omissions, or stale facts could misdirect containment. Commanders release only verified briefs.

3. Mission-Impact Cyber Risk Picture for Commanders. Value: high because mission context supports prioritization. Feasibility: low until data ownership and mappings exist. Risk: high. Uneven site coverage could distort priorities, and compiling the data could expose sensitive relationships.

Prioritization favors reviewable drafting first, then operational summaries, and finally data fusion. Autonomous blocking and personnel scoring remain deferred, regardless of score, because their consequences require separate safety and rights reviews.

EXHIBIT 2 **Prioritization Scores**

Candidate	Value (40%)	Feasibility (30%)	Risk manageability (30%)*	Score	Decision
P1 RMF control implementation statements	4	5	3	4.0	Advance (Phase 1)
P2 Incident executive brief	5	3	2	3.5	Advance (Phase 2)
P3 Mission-impact risk picture	5	2	2	3.2	Advance (Phase 3)
D1 Autonomous indicator blocking	4	3	1	2.8	Defer
D2 Insider-threat personnel scoring	3	3	1	2.4	Defer

**All scales 1–5, 5 = favorable. A proposed management aid, not an MIT-prescribed formula; the score informs but does not replace judgment. Override rule: a risk-manageability score of 1 (irreversible or rights-affecting harm) means deferral regardless of total.*

3 AI Adoption Roadmap

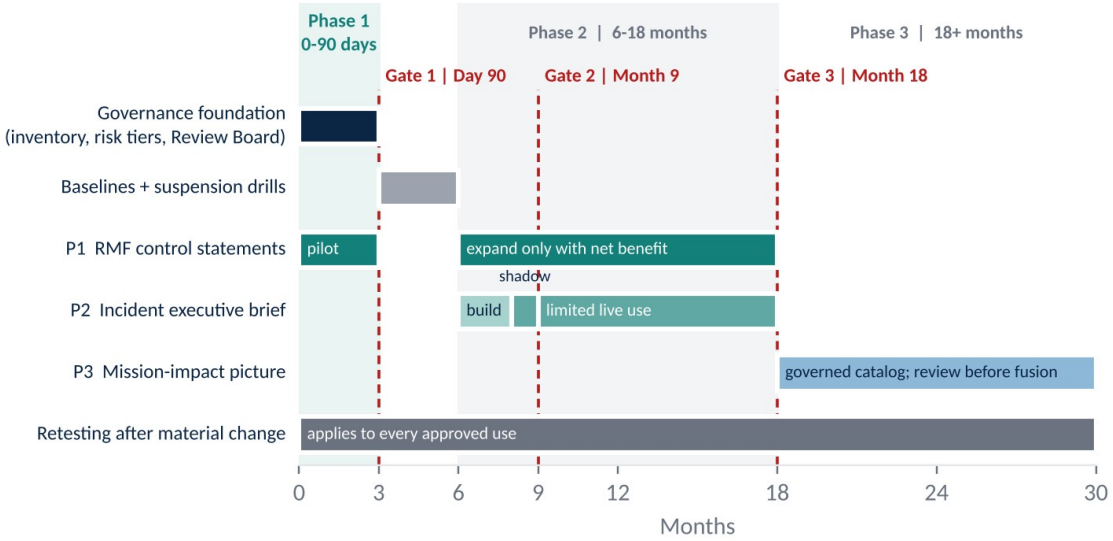
Phase 1, Days 0–90: quick win. Ten security managers will pilot control-statement drafting on two package updates. This measurable task allows verification before AO submission. Resources include one governance analyst, a technical evaluator, part-time privacy reviewers, an approved environment, and two training sessions. Establish the inventory, risk tiers, and AI Review Board. By Day 30, assess baseline reviewer skill and confirm data permissions; qualify reviewers before any release, no later than Day 90. Gate 1 tests 50 held-out statements against assessor-validated evidence: zero unsupported material claims or critical omissions, full traceability, and qualified reviewers. Months 3–6 will prepare baselines and suspension drills; expansion requires demonstrated net benefit.

Phase 2, Months 6–18: medium-term bets. Build incident briefing with 60 curated cases, read-only integration, a data steward, and commander training. Gate 2 at Month 9 requires 30 days of shadow use that meets Gate 1 integrity standards, plus a successful suspension exercise, before limited live use.

Phase 3, Month 18 onward: long-term ambition. Resource data engineering, classification expertise, and a governed catalog. Gate 3 requires classification review before fusion, AO approval of the processing boundary, and commander validation of mission mappings.

The Board recommends at each gate; the Branch Chief decides within delegated authority. ADKAR links training to demonstrated ability and monthly reinforcement (Prosci, n.d.). Ng's pilot-first sequence informs this roadmap, which I adapted to 90 days (Ng, 2018).

EXHIBIT 3 **Evidence Required Before Expansion**



Bars show planned activity from Section 3; dashed lines mark the evidence gates. No phase expands until its gate is passed.

Phase	Resources (named)	Governance checkpoint	Decision rule
1. Quick win Days 0–90	Talent: governance analyst, technical evaluator, part-time privacy reviewers. Tech: approved environment. Change: 2 training sessions	Gate 1: 50 held-out statements vs. assessor-validated evidence	Zero unsupported material claims or critical omissions; full traceability; all reviewers qualified. Failure: correct and retest on fresh cases
2. Medium-term Months 6–18	Data: data steward, 60 curated incident cases. Tech: read-only integration. Change: commander training	Gate 2 (Month 9): 30 days of shadow use plus a suspension exercise	Gate 1 integrity standards met in shadow; if cases are unrepresentative, extend shadow use rather than lower the bar
3. Long-term Month 18+	Data: governed catalog, data engineering. Talent: classification expertise. Sustained sponsorship	Gate 3: classification review, AO boundary approval, commander validation of mappings	No data fusion before classification clearance; commanders test usefulness in exercises before operational use

4 Risk, Governance, and Success Metrics

Technical risk is highest: fabricated, omitted, or stale evidence. Applying the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) AI RMF Measure and Manage functions, the system owner tests held-out cases and qualified reviewers verify material claims against sources (NIST, 2023, 2024). A release gate blocks missing approvals or source records; it does not automatically determine factual truth.

Organizational risk: review becomes a rubber stamp under speed pressure. Applying Module 5 accountability and human oversight (MIT Professional Education, 2026), the governance lead qualifies reviewers, audits source checks monthly, and retests after material changes. Accountability is the strongest design feature; actual reviewer performance remains vulnerable. A proposed 2% override flag prompts investigation, not automatic suspension.

Data risk: unauthorized disclosure or sensitive compilation. Under Govern and Map, the data steward checks provenance, markings, and access; qualified classification personnel review aggregation before processing (Information Security Oversight Office, 2017).

Month 12 measures are: (1) drafting time reduced 40%, with a 25% Day 90 target, including verification and rework; (2) zero escaped unsupported material claims or critical omissions; (3) verified briefing time reduced 30% without completeness loss; (4) all identified uses registered by Day 90 and 90% of routine requests decided on time; (5) all releasing reviewers qualified and 80% eligible-task adoption.

An escaped material error stops affected releases and expansion. The Branch Chief accepts bounded pilot uncertainty and workload risk in writing for 90 days; AO and commander authorities remain separate. Exhibits 4–6 define controls, measurement, and workforce implications.

EXHIBIT 4 **Risk Safeguards and Escalation**

Risk	Safeguard	Owner	Trigger	Residual risk
Technical: fabricated, omitted, stale evidence. Likely / severe.	Accountability → verify every material claim → source links, held-out tests, and approval gate. The gate checks required records; people verify truth.	System Owner; ISSM Lead; Incident Commander	Any escaped material error: suspend. Failed qualification: retrain; no release.	Bounded draft uncertainty (Branch Chief, 90 days); AO retains security risk.
Organizational: review under speed pressure. Likely / major.	Meaningful oversight → qualified release only → monthly source audits, version log, and retesting after material change.	Director of AI Governance	Override rate below 2%: investigate against case mix and source audits. Untested change: suspend.	Added review workload (Branch Chief).
Data: disclosure or sensitive compilation. Possible / severe.	Minimum necessary data → permitted inputs and review before fusion → provenance, access, marking, and retention checks.	Data Steward; classification authority	Unresolved marking or unapproved tool: stop affected processing pending review.	Disclosure or legal noncompliance cannot be accepted for productivity.

EXHIBIT 5 Twelve-Month Scorecard

Measure	Method and baseline	Target and milestone	Cadence	Owner	Escalation threshold
1. Net drafting effort	Median staff hours per comparable package, incl. verification and rework, vs. matched manual baseline (~400 hrs assumed)	−25% by Day 90; −40% by Month 12	Monthly	ISSM Lead	Below 25%: sponsor review. Below 10%: redesign or stop.
2. Release integrity	Escaped unsupported claims or critical omissions per released product; source links and named approval	Zero escapes; 100% traceable and signed	Every release	Dir. AI Governance	Any escape → suspend and investigate
3. Verified brief time	Median time from source cutoff to approved brief, matched by severity; completeness checklist	−30% by Month 12; no completeness decline	Monthly (live)	Incident Response Lead	Completeness decline → return to shadow
4. Governance coverage	Uses registered, reconciled monthly with procurement and system records; decision times	100% registered by Day 90; 90% of Tier 1–2 requests on time by Month 12	Monthly	Review Board Chair	Unregistered use → 10-day remediation
5. Reviewer readiness and adoption	Blind seeded-error drill; share of eligible tasks using the approved workflow	100% qualified (≥95% caught, all critical caught); 80% adoption	Quarterly drill; monthly use	Dir. AI Governance	Below 80% for two months → redesign

Baselines are established in Days 0–90. Freed capacity (about $173,000 a year at the Month 12 target) counts as cash savings only when contractor or overtime spending is avoided; training, platform, and evaluation costs are tracked separately.

ISSM = Information System Security Manager. All numerical targets are proposed.

EXHIBIT 6 Task Exposure and Workforce Development

Task and proposed exposure	Task-specific rationale and evidence	Human role and accountable owner
Control-statement drafting: proposed high exposure	Repeated artifact synthesis and standard formats; validate task time, usable drafts, errors, and rework in the two pilot packages.	AI assists synthesis and replaces some first-draft writing. Humans retain interpretation and attestation. ISSM Lead develops evidence-review skill.
Incident summarization: proposed high exposure	Bounded source summaries recur; validate on 60 cases by severity, record quality, omissions, and verification time.	AI assists summarization; people retain uncertainty assessment and response decisions. Incident Response Lead coaches source challenge and incident judgment.

In response to mission pressure, the ISSM Lead records verified hours reassigned to risk analysis each month and checks review quality. Over three to five years, evaluate shifts toward evidence evaluation and mission interpretation. Do not infer job losses from task exposure. Validate benefit before extending AI authority.

5 Leadership Commitment

Continuity leadership at the Defense Intelligence Agency taught me to look beyond the existence of procedures. I need to know whether people can execute them when systems are unavailable and information is incomplete. I apply that practical test to AI governance.

I will require teams to rehearse the process for withholding an AI product: who raises the concern, who stops release, what replaces the tool, and who decides when it can return. A signed approval is meaningful only when the reviewer has source access, time, and the competence to challenge a convincing answer.

I will protect commanders who act on our products, the missions they lead, and analysts who identify uncertainty. Analysts will have a route to escalate concerns without penalty. As drafting evolves, I will develop their evidence interpretation and incident judgment.

My development priority is technical evaluation depth. Within 90 days, I will lead a blind seeded-error exercise, explain its limitations to the sponsor, and demonstrate manual fallback. This course provided the frameworks to defend an approval, restriction, or suspension with evidence.

My governing principle: speed is earned through evidence, and accountability always has a name.

Tomeeka L. Sibley
Proposed Director of AI Governance

Decision Record

Recommended decision	Approve Phase 1: the 90-day control-statement pilot (ten security managers, two package updates), the AI inventory, three risk tiers, and the AI Review Board charter.
Conditions to proceed	By Day 30: confirm data permissions, register the protocol, assess reviewer baseline skill, and prepare fallback. Qualify reviewers before release, no later than Day 90. Until qualification and gate approval, activity is limited to preparation.
Residual risks accepted, and by whom	The Branch Chief accepts, in writing for 90 days, bounded pilot error, added review workload, and incomplete coverage. The AO keeps security-risk acceptance; commanders keep operational risk. Disclosure and legal noncompliance are never accepted.
Next action, owner, deadline	The Director of AI Governance submits the charter, named roles, delegated authorities, data-permission evidence, and test protocol to the Branch Chief within ten business days of approval.

APPENDIX A AI Opportunity Canvas

Organization: Sentinel Cyber Defense Branch (modeled) | Submitted by: Tomeeka L. Sibley | All six required fields plus feasibility for three prioritized uses (P1–P3) and two deferred candidates (D1–D2). Ratings are proposed assessments; risk describes consequence before safeguards are demonstrated.

Use Case Name	Business Function	Problem It Solves	AI Approach	Value Rating	Feasibility Rating	Risk Rating
P1 AI-Drafted Control Implementation Statements for RMF Authorization Packages	Cybersecurity compliance and authorization preparation	Twelve annual package updates at an assumed 400 writing hours each consume 4,800 hours and pull security managers away from risk analysis.	Retrieval + generation from approved policies, configurations, and scan evidence, each statement citing source and date. Security manager checks, revises, and attests. Approved document bundles first; automated retrieval later.	**HIGH** 40% reduction would free ~1,920 gross hours a year; valued at about $173,000 a year in fully loaded labor cost. Counted as cash savings only where spending is avoided; no shorter authorization cycle assumed.	**HIGH** Bounded pilot only: artifacts and reviewers exist; permitted uploads confirmed by Day 30.	**MEDIUM** Governance/ethical: false assurance to the AO. Controls: claim-to-source checks, explicit unknowns, reviewer signature, AI assistance disclosed. AI never attests or accepts risk.
P2 Evidence-Grounded Cyber Incident Executive Brief	Incident response and command communication	An assumed three to four hours per major incident go to manual updates, so leaders receive late or inconsistent information.	Retrieval + summarization from approved incident records (read-only), with source timestamps, disputed facts, and unknowns labeled. Commander approves; AI cannot execute response actions.	**HIGH** Returns analyst time to response and improves decision context; measured on like-severity cases, including verification time.	**MEDIUM** Needs permissions, 60 curated cases, a qualified evaluator, and approved integration; synthetic cases if needed.	**HIGH** Invented indicators, omissions, stale records, or disclosure could misdirect containment. Controls: source verification, shadow use, named release, logging, manual fallback.
P3 Mission-Impact Cyber Risk Picture for Commanders	Mission assurance and continuity	Cyber and continuity records are analyzed separately, so commanders cannot see which mission-essential functions a cyber event threatens.	Analysis + classification linking approved cyber records to human-validated mission dependencies; shows evidence, coverage gaps, uncertainty, and alternative priorities. Decision support only.	**HIGH** Better mission context for resource prioritization; usefulness validated in exercises first.	**LOW** Data ownership, catalog, classification review, and mission mappings are unresolved.	**HIGH** Uneven site coverage may under-protect some missions (fairness); compilation may reveal sensitive relationships. Classification review precedes fusion.

DEFERRED CANDIDATES

Use Case Name	Business Function	Problem It Solves	AI Approach	Value Rating	Feasibility Rating	Risk Rating
D1 Autonomous Indicator Blocking via Security Orchestration (deferred)	Network defense operations	Analysts push block rules for confirmed indicators by hand, slowing response.	Agentic automation: AI extracts indicators and pushes firewall blocks without human approval.	**HIGH** Response in seconds instead of minutes.	**MEDIUM** Tooling exists; integration is moderate.	**CRITICAL** Could disrupt mission traffic before review. A clean briefing record would not authorize it; it needs its own safety case, simulation, rollback test, and delegated authority.
D2 AI Behavioral Scoring for Insider-Threat Monitoring (deferred)	Security and personnel	Insider-threat analysts face high alert volumes.	Classification: scores personnel activity for anomalies.	**MEDIUM** Some triage relief; alert quality uncertain.	**MEDIUM** Data available; legal prerequisites unmet.	**CRITICAL** Rights-affecting: could influence clearance or employment decisions. Legal authority, privacy, civil liberties, and fairness review required first.

APPENDIX B Governance Operating Model

Governance follows the Module 5 chain of principle → policy → enforcement mechanism (MIT Professional Education, 2026). The risk tier sets the route, so review effort matches consequence and routine work moves fast.

EXHIBIT B1 Risk Tiers and Approval Routes

Tier	Boundary	Approval route	Decision target
1 Routine	Internal, reversible drafting in a permitted environment; no sensitive fusion or official risk record	Register; owner review; policy attestation	5 business days
2 Elevated	Outputs enter official evidence or inform risk acceptance (P1)	Board reviews tests and conditions; Branch Chief authorizes; ISSM verifies content	10 business days after complete evidence
3 Consequential	Outputs inform incident or mission decisions, or aggregate sensitive data (P2, P3)	Independent evaluation; privacy and legal review; security authorization; shadow testing; suspension readiness	When evidence is sufficient; missing prerequisites block use

A local tier, not a legal determination of "high-impact AI." OMB Memorandum M-25-21 (Office of Management and Budget [OMB], 2025) excludes AI used in national security systems; NSPM-11 directs separate governance (The White House, 2026). Legal and security leads confirm applicable policy before use.

EXHIBIT B2 Decision Rights

Decision	Accountable role	Review or execution
Gate decision or restart	Branch Chief (within delegated authority)	Board recommends; governance lead records conditions, scope, expiry, dissent, and residual risk
P1 statement release	ISSM Lead	Qualified ISSM checks material claims against evidence and signs; AO separately retains authorization and security-risk acceptance
P2 brief release	Incident Commander	Qualified analyst checks evidence; commander approves and retains response decisions
P3 mission prioritization	Mission Commander	Mission owners validate mappings; AO approves the processing boundary
Classification question	Designated classification authority	Data steward screens and refers; new questions go to an Original Classification Authority
Immediate suspension	Director of AI Governance	Any user can raise a stop; system owner disables the workflow and preserves logs

EXHIBIT B3 Six Responsible AI Dimensions

Dimension	Status	Assessment and condition
Accountability	**Strongest**	Separate sponsor, reviewer, AO, and commander authorities; effectiveness must still be shown in gate records and exercises
Safety and reliability	**Most vulnerable**	Test fabrication, omission, stale evidence, and malicious instructions embedded in records; a small passing test does not prove future safety
Privacy and confidentiality	**Most consequential**	Permitted data and aggregation unresolved; minimize data, restrict access and retention, review before processing
Transparency	**Strong**	Show source identifiers, dates, uncertainty, and AI assistance; a citation must support the actual claim
Human oversight	**Conditional**	Reviewers need time, competence, source access, and override authority; manual workflow stays available
Fairness	**Watch**	P3 could under-represent some sites or missions; compare coverage and omissions by site; personnel scoring deferred

EXHIBIT B4 Suspension and Restart Protocol

Pause triggers: an escaped material error or critical omission, any disclosure, an unreviewed release, a failed reviewer qualification, or an untested change to model, prompt, data source, or permissions. Actions: stop affected releases, revert to the manual workflow, notify the sponsor and security and privacy officials through existing incident channels, and log cause and corrective action. Restart requires independent retesting, a fallback exercise, sponsor approval, and AO or commander concurrence where their authority applies.

APPENDIX C Evaluation and Adoption Plan

EXHIBIT C1 Test Protocol

Stage	Evidence required and failure action
Gate 1 Day 90	50 held-out statements, stratified across control types and evidence conditions, compared with current assessor-validated records (not prose similarity). Check every material claim, source, date, and contradiction. Failure: correct and retest on fresh held-out material.
Gate 2 Month 9	60 incident cases (30 development, 30 held out) spanning severity, record quality, stale data, and missing facts; then 30 days of shadow use. Test false indicators and malicious instructions embedded in records.
Gate 3 Month 18+	Classification and access reviews clear processing before fusion. An independent evaluator and mission owners test mappings, omissions, uncertainty, and site coverage in exercises.
Every change	Retest after any change to model, prompt, retrieval source, permissions, or task. Record visible model versions; if a version cannot be identified, rerun a fixed test before consequential use.

A zero-error sample is a release rule, not proof of zero future errors. Report case and claim counts, coverage, discovered errors, and uncertainty; a second evaluator resolves disputed cases. Keep training examples separate from held-out tests.

EXHIBIT C2 ADKAR (Awareness, Desire, Knowledge, Ability, Reinforcement) Adoption Plan

ADKAR stage and timing	Action	Observable evidence
Awareness Days 1–15	Branch Chief explains why verified drafting matters and what stays human-owned	Reviewers explain the release boundary in a teach-back
Desire Days 1–30	ISSMs and team leads co-design the workflow; job-impact concerns logged and answered	Concern log with owners; unresolved barriers reported to sponsor
Knowledge Days 15–45	Two role-based sessions: source checking, privacy, uncertain facts, escalation	Attendance alone does not qualify a reviewer
Ability Days 30–90	Blind seeded-error exercise; failed reviewers retrain and retest	≥95% of seeded errors and every critical error caught
Reinforcement Monthly to Month 12	Team leads review use and source-check quality; sponsor removes barriers	Below 80% eligible-task adoption for two months → redesign

ADKAR per Prosci (n.d.), applied as the Module 6 change model (MIT Professional Education, 2026).

APPENDIX D References and Document Control

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SOURCE AND VERIFICATION NOTES

NIST informs source verification, monitoring, and accountable roles; it does not prescribe the numerical gates. Ng supports feasible pilots; the 90-day scope is local. Platform access does not authorize every data category or workflow. Legal and security leads confirm current implementing policy before use. NSPM-11 directs national-security AI governance and evaluation methods; no claim is made here about whether all implementing standards have been issued. The 2% override flag and workforce exposure ratings are proposed hypotheses to validate. Fabricated indicators are treated as a failure scenario, not a reported SCDB pilot result.

AI ASSISTANCE

Generative AI (OpenAI, 2026) assisted with review, editing, source checks, and formatting. Staffing, workloads, ratings, targets, and test plans are proposed assumptions. No completed pilot, realized benefits, or job displacement is claimed. Author review of the personal commitment and final citations precedes submission.

VALUE BASIS

The cost-equivalent value uses the 2026 GS-13, step 5 Washington-Baltimore hourly rate of $66.14 (Office of Personnel Management [OPM], 2026) plus OMB's 36.25% civilian fringe benefit factor (Office of Management and Budget, 2008), or about $90.12 per hour. At the Month 12 target, 1,920 hours × $90.12 ≈ $173,000 a year; at the Day 90 pilot target (two packages, 25%), 200 hours ≈ $18,000. These are planning assumptions. Finance validates actual grades, contractor rates, and net value after training, platform, and evaluation costs.

GLOSSARY

Authorizing Official (AO): the senior official who formally accepts a system's security risk and approves it to operate.

Classification by compilation: combining individually unclassified items in a way that reveals information classified as a whole.

Held-out test: an evaluation using cases the AI workflow was not tuned on, so results reflect new work.

Information System Security Manager (ISSM): the person responsible for a system's security program and authorization documentation.

Material claim: a statement that could change a security, incident, or mission decision.

Risk Management Framework (RMF): the federal process for selecting, assessing, and authorizing a system's security controls.

Seeded-error drill: a test in which known errors are planted in drafts to measure whether reviewers catch them.

Shadow use: running AI alongside the current process without relying on its output so that results can be compared safely.

WORD COUNT

Sections 1–5 narrative: S1 190; S2 237; S3 227; S4 244; S5 188. Total 1086. All sections meet their required ranges. Exhibits, summary, decision record, and appendices are excluded.

VERSION HISTORY

Version	Date	Change
3.2	October 26, 2026	Applied accuracy, grammar, and reference review: Ng (2018) date; GenAI.mil, OpenAI, MIT, OMB, and NSPM-11 citations; Section 4 heading; Phase 1 timing; acronym definitions; role-name consistency; grammar fixes; professional formatting with classification banners.
3.1	October 23, 2026	Applied Assignments 1–7 feedback: task exposure, capacity reinvestment, original leadership, approval-gate limits, reviewer timing, source consistency, and consolidated charts.
3.0	October 19, 2026	Prior PDF baseline: portfolio, readiness scorecard, risk register, gates, ADKAR, and decision record.
2.1 / 2.0	October 2026	Earlier SCDB evidence-validation and governance revisions.
1.0	September 26, 2026	Initial Aegis scenario baseline.

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